

Music in Western Civilization

Topic 4 .2 – The High Baroque I
Johann Sebastian Bach

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2026

Keyboard Instruments



- Baroque Keyboard instruments:
- Clavichord 古钢琴,
- **Harpsichord 古键琴/羽管键琴**
- **Organ (pipe organ) 管風琴**



- From late Baroque:
- early piano(fortepiano) 早期钢琴,

Then: modern piano (pianoforte)

- *From clavichord to modern piano*
  https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4uCCw_hmILA

Pipe Organ in Paris (France): Notre Dame



Passau (Germany)
Dom St. Stephen



Pipe Organ in China

北京35 中金帆音乐厅 Golden Sail Concert Hall, Beijing



Pipe Organ in China

National Centre for the Performing Arts, Beijing

北京国家大剧院 2001



HK Cultural Centre Concert Hall

香港文化中心 1989





J.S. Bach 1685-1750

- ***Passacaglia and Fugue in C Minor* BWV 582**
- (written between 1706-1713)

- https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=nVoFLM_BDgs

- A *repeated bass line* in the pedal,
- Moving upper parts,
- Feel the solemnness and well-structured sections,
- Thick texture,
- Overwhelming sonority!!

Baroque Musical Forms



- *Instrumental* forms: **Sonata** 奏鸣曲, **Suite*** 组曲, **Fugue** 赋格曲, **Concerto** 協奏曲,
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- *Vocal* forms: **Cantata** 清唱剧, **Oratorio** 神曲, **Mass/Missa** 弥撒曲, **Requiem** Mass安魂弥撒曲

- **Opera** 歌剧 : solo **aria** 咏叹调, **recit**ative 宣叙调, duet, trio, chorus and orchestra.
- q
- *Suite : a number of dances popular in France, England, Italy, Spain and Germany

The Two Giants of the High Baroque

- Bach 巴赫
- &
- Handel 韩德尔

Johann Sebastian **Bach**, 1685-1750

Father of Music

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Td5QKVyyzwg



born in Eisenach, Germany

worked in

Weimar 魏玛,

Köthen,

Leipzig 莱比锡

died in **Leipzig**

- **Johann Sebastian Bach 巴赫 1685-1750**

- Weimar-Koethen-Leipzig as court musician, Kappelmeister (chapel master).

- Bach Gesellschaft (Bach Company) started to publish Bach's works from 1851, replaced by Neue Bachgesellschaft in 1900. From 1950, **B**ach-**W**erkes-**V**erzeichnis (BWV) numbering was added from **BWV** 001- over 1,200 including
- Instrumental: (for various solo instruments and orchestra) **suite组曲**, **sonata奏鸣曲**, **concerto协奏曲**, sinfonia交响曲, chorale prelude圣咏前奏曲, **fugue赋格曲**, toccata触技曲, passacaglia , etc.
- Vocal: **cantata清唱剧**, **oratorio神曲, missa/mass弥撒曲**, passion受难曲.

- In 1705, Bach took a 1-year leave and *walked* from Arnstadt to Lübeck (250 miles) listening to the other composer Buxtehude's organ recital.

Bach's Work Areas




0 75 150 km
0 75 150 mi
DENMARK
Baltic Sea
North Sea
Kiel Bay
Kiel
Rostock
Lübeck
Bremerhaven
Hamburg
Emden
Bremen
POLAND
BERLIN
NETHERLANDS
Hannover
Magdeburg
Duisburg
Essen
Kassel
Leipzig
Düsseldorf
Cologne
Dresden
Bonn
BELGIUM
Frankfurt am Main
Wiesbaden
CZECH REPUBLIC
Mannheim
LUX.
Stuttgart
Danube
FRANCE
Munich
AUSTRIA
LIECHTENSTEIN
SWITZERLAND

The Danube / Der Donau



Bach's **Instrumental** Music

- 6 *Brandenburg Concertos*, solo concertos, 4 *Orchestral Suites*,
- Solo Partitas & Sonatas for Violin, Cello, etc., Organ & other keyboard works (48 Preludes & Fugues for Clavier),
- The Art of Fugue
- Trio Sonata

- Mostly used solo instruments: **violin, cello, harpsichord, organ**.
- String orchestra; strings with flutes, oboes, bassoons, horns, trumpets & timpani.

Bach's Major **Vocal** Music

- Over 200 **Cantatas** 清唱劇 (in German). average 30 minutes each
- **Mass**: Mass in B minor (in Latin). 2 hours
- **Passion**: St. Matthew Passion (in German). 3 hours
- **Oratorio**: Christmas Oratorio (in German). 1 hour 45 min

Overall Description of Bach's Music

- **Absolute** instrumental **music**無標題音樂: non-programmatic nature,
- *Melody*: contrapuntal lines, linear/horizontal structure, masculine cadence, chromaticism,
- *Functional Harmony* from ***Counterpoint*** 对位,
- *Rhythmic* vitality, and florid bass line
- Brilliant sonority & timbre,
- Religious sentiment, clear structure,
- Bach's music illustrates the **Baroque Grandeur with solemnness** hence he is called
- ***the Father of Music***

- The in-depth sentiment in Bach's vocal music

- **St. Matthew Passion,** BWV 244 (**Thomanerchor**, Leipzig)
- *St. Thomas Church*, built in 13th century as *Romanesque,* changed to *Gothic*, renovated as a *Lutheran* Church in 16th century
- https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Hl5ftd8uOxY&feature=related total 2 hr 50 min
- For soloists, double choir and double orchestra: note the solemnity, complexity and seriousness of the music. Only performed twice in Bach's lifetime.

- **Magnificat,** BWV 243 (Harnoncourt)
- https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=41blIyHQ0hs
- For soloists, 5-part chorus and orchestra

- **Cantata** No. 147. Jesu bleibet meine Freude (Jesu, Joy of Man's Desiring) (Koopman)
- https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=WUo7tQOvapE

- **Solo instrumental works**

- ***Fugue*** in Eb major from WTC Bk. II (harpsichord)
- https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=k2v6U546tNM

Toccata & ***Fugue*** in d minor (Karl Richter, Ottobeuren)

- https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=DquxPwY91MI&feature=related
- Beginning & 3'15"
- Stops 4'25"
- Pedal 5'40"

- Cello ***Suite*** No.1 : Prelude (Casals)
  https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KX1YtvFZOj0&feature=fvst

Orchestral Works

Concerto for violin in E major, Movt. I

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=1J-DklWUw0A St. Petersburg

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=DgfyryZJES4

Hilary Hahn, Deutsche Kammertphilharmonie Bremen

*Orchestral **Suite*** No. 3 in D major: Movt. II, Air

- https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=U7RYSQvrUrc Sky scene
- *the serenity of the music.

- http://www.youtube.com/watch?v=la81066xEUo&feature=related
- pop arrangement

- ***Brandenburg Concertos*** Nos.1-6, BWV 1046-1051 (1721, dedicated to the Margrave of Brandenburg)
- https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=QSgkeOwTVx8 No.2
- https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=mB1M2HaEbI4 No.3
- Münchener Bach Orchester - Karl Richter
- *the rhythmic vitality, the running bass line, the complex texture, the building up of climax.
- ***Double Concerto for 2 violins***. BWV 1043
- https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=PAfqxmEvaG0
- Arabella Steinbacher & Akiko Suwanai 諏訪内晶子 1990 Tchaikovsky Competition No.1, youngest ever to win at 22 years old.
- 2nd movt: 3:55
- https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Qcp8pvRkooY Anne-Sophie Mutter

- ***The Art of Fugue*** , BWV 1080
- Contrapunctus :15 fugues, 4 canons

- Contrapunctus VII: Augmentation & Diminution
- https://www.teoria.com/en/articles/kdf/VII/ harpsichord

- https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=N6sUlZa-IrU string version

- https://musescore.com/user/4215981/scores/7940741 open score

Baroque music reincarnated

- Original version: *JS Bach: Minuet in G major*
- https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KqSAGwa49MM for harpsichord

- Arranged for guitar
- https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=lNg9iMQDnIM

- Adopted as a pop song in 1965
- *A lover's Concerto*
- https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=DtH8Oz3h5t8 USA
- https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=VWsI7kADesE Japan

The Revival of Baroque Music

- 1. Baroque music is still used in movies, tv dramas, jingles, promotional music, etc.
- 2. Bach's music had disappeared for 80 years after he died, now his music is being enjoyed worldwide.

- *Air on G strings* : https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=03Gn4loM7As The Swingle Singers
- *Organ Fugue in E minor*
- https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=PhRa3REdozw organ
- https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=jbbL0rdCbJk Swingle Singers
- *Concerto in F major. II: Largo*
- https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=t5QgLnweRxQ harpsichord & strings
- https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=LpG648SVPrM Swingle Singers

- *Toccata & Fugue in D minor* on electric guitar. Laura Lace (Latvia)
- https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=D8-T09qB6PI

- *Bach: Bourrée* rock band
- https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=e6Kyap5BTfo

Bach's music in movie soundtracks

- From 1931-2001
- https://www.bach-cantatas.com/Movie/Year.htm

- Bach's music will last till
- the end of the world !!